

```
box.txt
1 recommend 10 movies, use letters when listing your movies.
2 A) "Titanic"
3 B) "The Godfather"
4 C) "Forrest Gump"
5 D) "The Silence of the Lambs"
6 E) "The Shawshank Redemption"
7 F) "The Dark Knight"
8 G) "The Godfather, Part II"
9 H) "The Lord of the Rings: The Fellowship of the Ring"
10 I) "The Lord of the Rings: The Two Towers"
11 J) "The Lord of the Rings: The Return of the King"
```

## Show and Tell

### Constructing a Better Prompt

One of the more impressive aspects of the GPT-3 model is that it can give quality answers to vague prompts. If we want to increase the quality of the responses, we need to improve the prompt. Use **show and tell** as a guideline when developing a prompt.

For show and tell we want to focus on 3 things:

1. Giving the model clear instructions (tell)
2. Giving the model an example (show)
3. Giving the model clear instructions and an example (show and tell)

Let's start with a simple prompt that does not make use of the show and tell principles.

recommend 10 movies

TRY IT

If you want to try other prompts. You can use the `RESET` button below to clear the text in the file on the left. Then use the `TRY IT` button to generate another response.

RESET

Command was successfully executed.

Most likely, you see movies that are popular, critically acclaimed, or maybe you have never heard of the film before. Since you are asking for ten titles, the model numbers each film. If you run the prompt a couple of times you may see the numbering like `1.` or even `1)`. Since we are not being specific, the model is not very consistent.

We can produce a better list of films by telling the model what features you are looking for. Instead of numbers, we want a list that uses numbers to identify each item.

recommend 10 movies, use letters when listing your movies.

TRY IT

RESET

Command was successfully executed.

The model now produces a list with letters instead of numbers. But the list can be just as inconsistent in terms of formatting. This is where the show principle comes into play. In addition to the prompt, show the model how you want the list formatted. Each line in the list should contain a letter followed by a closing parenthesis, and the film title should appear between quotes.

recommend 10 movies, use letters when listing your movies.  
A) "Titanic"  
B) "The Godfather"

TRY IT

RESET

Command was successfully executed.

RESET

Command was successfully executed.

For more precision, we can combine the show and tell principles. Tell the prompt that you want 10 horror movies in a list that uses letters. Then show the model how you want the list formatted.

recommend 10 horror movies, use letters when listing your movies.  
A) "The Ring"  
B) "The Exorcist"

TRY IT

RESET

Command was successfully executed.

Using the show and tell principles, you can dramatically change the type and format of the model's response. With the right combination, you can improve the quality of the results, which is more desirable than the standard GPT-3 response.

Label the following items as examples of the show principle, the tell principle, or both.

- The item below is an example of the tell principle

give me a list of the 5 players who hit the most home runs
- The item below is an example of the show principle

give me a list of 10 colors  
• Color 1: red  
• Color 2: blue
- The item below is an example of the show and tell principles

give me a list of the 10 most popular pizza toppings.  
1) Cheese  
2) Pepperoni

The correct answers are:

- The item below is an example of the tell principle

give me a list of the 5 players who hit the most home runs

This is the tell principle because we are giving a specific prompt and not demonstrating what the results should look like.
- The item below is an example of the show principle

give me a list of 10 colors  
• Color 1: red  
• Color 2: blue

This is the show principle because we have a rather generic prompt but provide a specific format for the output.
- The item below is an example of the show and tell principles

give me a list of the 10 most popular pizza toppings.  
1) Cheese  
2) Pepperoni

This is an example of both the show and tell principles because we have a specific prompt and a specific format for the output.

Check It

Next